HOPEFULL ROGAINE – THE SEQUEL, 4TH MAY 2003

PLANNERS REPORT

Hi Everybody,

Firstly, my apologies to all those people who planned to visit control number 62, where the control flag was not where I marked it on the map. I originally planned to put a control in one of the erosion gullies slightly south of where I marked it on the map (that is where I marked it on my first planning map). Then when I came to put the control out, my brain took a little holiday while climbing up from 101, and I parked the control flag in the first erosion gully I came to, a very nice spot it was too, and carefully moved the control circle on the map a bit further north to match, not realising I was in completely in the wrong stream catchment!!! Then off I tootled to put out 104 without giving it a second thought. Several people commented at the finish that it was in the wrong place, and when Susan pointed out what I had done on the way home on Sunday (good view from SH 1 near Seventeen Valley)… bugger!

We only know of one person who connected 101 and 104 and didn't find 62 – award yourself another 60 points.

The rest of the controls were all correctly placed and marked, and they all survived the windy conditions during the week before the event.

I spent about 24 hours (5 or 6 visits) on the hills planning and putting out controls, and it took another 12 hours (in 3 visits, with some help) to pick them up again. Visiting the landowners beforehand took 4 visits of about 2 hours each, to explain what the event was all about and to enlist their permission.

We have had lots of positive enthusiastic feedback about the views from the ridge tops – one of the reasons why I chose the area – and I hope that all of you who visited control 73 enjoyed the adventure of the canyon, it was a control site that was too good not to use.

Only one person on the 6-hour course didn't visit the water control (71), and there was still some water left when we collected the bottles up. It was a relief to know I put enough out, as it was a pretty hot day.

We heard of one encounter with a live electric fence: Gillian McCloy accidentally touched the back of her hand on one of the hot wires on the bull paddock fence near control 10 (while helping her team mate through the fence), got thrown to the ground by the jolt and had numb fingers for a good ten minutes afterwards. All the hot wires were treated with great caution after that!

Dan Dollimore, the winner of the 6-hour event, has provided his route through the controls. I was hugely relieved that he did not manage to get them all!!!
10, 23, 41, 102, 34, 31, 42, 33, 83, 53, 74, 63, 75, 104, 91, 62, 101, 54, 72, 61, 71, 70, 82 (roughly 3 hours), 40, 90, 81, 100, 80, 50, 51, 103, 52, 73, 60, 32, 26, 30, 25, 22, 20. Total 2290, out of a possible 2330.

Jenni Adams and Carsten Jorgensen, who got 1000 points to win the 3-hour, collected the following controls (guessing the order)
20, 21, 50, 51, 80, 100, 81, 90, 40, 103, 82, 70, 71, 60, 73, 26, 30, 25, 22.
They were 6.5mins late back so had a 70 point penalty.

Special thanks to Alan Holdaway for doing all the administration for the entries and for making the clipcards. Thanks to various MOC members for helping to put up and take down the start/finish area, and for helping with the registration. Thanks to Graeme for doing the barbeque.

And of course, thanks to the landowners for allowing us virtually free rein of their properties:
Mrs Phyllis Balfour (owner) and Geoff Boyce (manager) of Vernon (the large north eastern portion of the map), Arnold van Asch of "Burtergill", to the south
Jeremy Turnbull of "Glengyle", on the eastern side of Redwood Pass Road
and Tony Turnbull of "Jedburgh" which is the bulk of the western part of the map.

Thanks everyone for coming along and supporting our event. We'll let you all know when next years event will be.

Barry Hope.

And a few words from the President of the Marlborough Orienteering Club.

On behalf of MOC I would like to congratulate and commend Barry for the work that he has done for this rogaine. I felt the course was very cleverly set out providing various options, route choices and decision-making considerations. The placement of some of the controls took us through some wonderful terrain and landscapes, which gave a great sense of exploration and adventure.

Quite a few people (mainly locals) came along who had never done (or heard of) a rogaine and thoroughly (unexpectedly) enjoyed themselves. It seems as though they particularly liked the mental challenge as much as the physical and were surprised how quickly time went by.

Including a rogaine in to our orienteering programme gives us the opportunity to provide another form of navigation sport to our members and to anybody else keen to come along whether they be first timers or experienced rogainers.

Marlborough is fantastic region for rogaining and we have plenty more potential courses up our sleeves. Watch this space.

We look forward to welcoming you some time next year.

Mondo Kopua